Australia, the parliament contributed to the reconciliation process with Aboriginal people by setting up the Council for Aboriginal Reconciliation in 2000 (O'Brien 2008, pp. 36–37). In Aceh, Indonesia, the regional parliament passed the Aceh Truth and Reconciliation bylaw, an historic step toward reconciliation in the province (Amnesty International 2014). On the other hand, parliaments have on occasion been responsible for escalating the intensity of conflict, such as in Rwanda in 1994, the Lebanese civil war during the 1970s and 1980s, Algerian unrest in 1990s, and the Ukrainian crisis in 2013, among others. In each of these cases, the conflicts arose from electoral resentment and the institutional arrangement of parliament, which gave an advantage to the majority, leaving minorities vulnerable.

MYANMAR'S LEGISLATURE

The establishment of the legislatures at the union and local levels in 2011 symbolized Myanmar's transition from a military to quasi-civilian rule. Myanmar was without a legislature for over two decades. Since then it has become an avenue for the people to address their issues and concerns through conventional legislative functions of representation, lawmaking, and oversight which people had not experienced for a generation. Asserting its autonomy with a non-partisan approach to oversight of the executive and with the inclusion since 2012 of the opposition figure Daw Aung San Suu Kyi as a legislator, the Hluttaw has become a symbol of Myanmar's transformation (Kean 2014, p. 65).

On the other hand, the Hluttaw faced a major institutional challenge while performing its functions. Institutionally, the legislature had serious constraints set by the 2008 Constitution. Firstly, the legislature had no check and balance mechanism on the military and it had little say on executive appointments.[2] The legislative oversight mechanism of the executive relied mainly on motions and questions raised during the plenary sessions. Secondly, the legislature had capacity constraints. Its members were new and so were the support staff, who received little or no training. Committees were still at their infancy and lacking technical competence. These issues were compounded by lack of facilities and services, such as offices and research services usually provided in established legislatures.

Christina Fink (2015, p. 327) has reflected on the work of Myanmar's legislature as supplementing the reform process despite its institutional